

Production Subscore

KEY POINTS



Key Points: Production



Internal structure

The Duolingo English Test has seven types of questions drawn from language testing research that measure different aspects of language proficiency⁵. Each of the question types contribute to two subscores.

- **Literacy:** C-test, writing, yes/no (text)
- **Conversation:** Speaking, dictation, elicited speech, yes/no (audio)
- **Comprehension:** C-test, dictation, elicited speech, yes/no (text), yes/no (audio)
- **Production:** Speaking and Writing

Key Points: Production



Internal structure

The Duolingo English Test has seven types of questions drawn from language testing research that measure different aspects of language proficiency⁵. Each of the question types contribute to two subscores.

- Literacy: Grammar and Vocabulary

- **Production:** Speaking and Writing

Key Points: Production



Which question types?

Key Points: Production



Which question types?

4:59



Respond to the question in at least 50 words

"A university plans to develop a new research center in your country. Some people want a center for business research, while others want a center for research in agriculture (farming). Which of these two kinds of research centers would you recommend, and why?"

Your response

I

Words: 0

NEXT

Key Points: Production



Which question types?

0:59



Write one or more sentences that describe the image



Your response

NEXT

Key Points: Production



Which question types?

1:30



Speak your answer to the question below

Talk about a book you read recently.

- What was the title?
- What was it about?
- How did you first hear of it?
- What did you like or dislike about it?

● RECORDING...



NEXT

Key Points: Production



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4:59

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RECORDING...



NEXT

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6.4 Extended Speaking and Writing Tasks

The writing and speaking tasks are scored by automated scoring algorithms developed by ML and NLP experts at Duolingo. There are two separate algorithms: one for the speaking tasks and one for the writing tasks. Currently, the scores for the tasks are estimated at the portfolio level—meaning that the speaking score that is included in the total score represents test taker performance on the four speaking tasks and the writing score represents test taker performance on the four writing tasks.

The speaking and writing scoring systems evaluate each task based on the features listed below.

- Grammatical accuracy
- Grammatical complexity
- Lexical sophistication
- Lexical diversity
- Task relevance
- Length
- Fluency & acoustic features (speaking)

Key Points: Production



6.4 Extended Speaking and Writing Tasks

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- Grammatical accuracy
 - Grammatical complexity
 - Lexical sophistication
 - Lexical diversity
 - Task relevance
 - Length
 - Fluency & acoustic features (speaking)

Key Points: Production



Scoring Criteria

- Grammatical accuracy & complexity
- Lexical sophistication & diversity
- Task relevance
- Length
- Fluency & acoustic features

Grammatical Accuracy & Complexity

- Mostly error-free sentences
- Wide range of grammar structures
- A variety of complex structures

Grammatical Accuracy & Complexity

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- Wide range of grammar structures
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Example: Simple Sentences

Question: *Describe the kind of accommodation you live in.*

I live in an apartment. I really like my apartment. It's modern. It's conveniently located. The apartment is in the city center. It's close to my school. It only takes me 10 minutes to walk to school. The apartment is a bit small. I'd like to find a bigger one in the future.

Example: Simple Sentences

Question: *Tell me about the kind of accommodation you live in.*

*I live in an apartment, **which I really like**. It's modern **and** conveniently located. **It** is in the city center **and** close to my school. **In fact**, it only takes me 10 minutes to walk **there**. **Since** the apartment is a bit small, I'd like to find a bigger one in the future.*

Lexical sophistication & diversity

- Wide range of vocabulary precisely
- Vocabulary that fits the style
- Correct collocations

Lexical sophistication & diversity

Synonyms

- Wide range of vocabulary precisely
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- Correct collocations

Lexical sophistication & diversity

Synonyms

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Academic, formal style

Lexical sophistication & diversity

Synonyms

- Wide range of vocabulary precisely
- Vocabulary that fits the style
- Correct collocations

Academic, formal style

Example: Repeated words

Question: *University students should be required to attend all classes. Do you agree or disagree with this statement?*

*I agree that university **students** should be required to attend all **classes** for two reasons. One reason **students** should be required to attend **classes** is for discipline. Without the pressure of mandatory attendance, many **students** might think that **classes** are not important. Most university **students** are teenagers or in their early twenties, thus are still learning how to manage their lives. Without mandatory attendance, I believe that many **students** will lack the discipline to attend **classes** on a consistent basis. Another reason is*

.....

Example: Repeated words

Question: *University students should be required to attend all classes. Do you agree or disagree with this statement?*

*I agree that university **students** should be required to attend all **classes** for two reasons. One reason **learners** should be required to attend **lessons** is for discipline. Without the pressure of mandatory attendance, many **students** might think that **classes** are not important. Most **freshmen** are teenagers or in their early twenties, thus are still learning how to manage their lives. Without mandatory attendance, I believe that many **students** would lack the discipline to attend **lectures** on a consistent basis. Another reason is*

.....

Task relevance

What is the task?

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Task relevance

- Fully answer all parts of the task

Task relevance

- Fully answer all parts of the task
- Present a clear position

Task relevance

- Fully answer all parts of the task
- Present a clear position
- Provide supporting ideas

4:52

Respond to the question in at least 50 words

“Films can tell us a lot about the country where they were made. What have you learned about another country from watching its movies?”

Your response

Words: 0

NEXT

4:52

“Films can tell us a lot about the country where they were made. What have you learned about another country from watching its movies?”

at least 50 words

Words: 0

NEXT

4:52

“Films can tell us a lot about the country where they were made. What have you learned about another country from watching its movies?”

at least 50 words

Words: 0

NEXT

4:52

“Films can tell us a lot about the country where they were made. What have you learned about another country from watching its movies?”

at least 50 words

Recount: Talk about your experience

NEXT

4:52

“Films can tell us a lot about the country where they were made. What have you learned about another country from watching its movies?”

at least 50 words

*Recount: Talk about your experience
Pick one country*

NEXT

4:52

“Films can tell us a lot about the country where they were made. What have you learned about another country from watching its movies?”

at least 50 words

Recount: Talk about your experience
Pick one country
2 things you learned

NEXT

4:52

“Films can tell us a lot about the country where they were made. What have you learned about another country from watching its movies?”

at least 50 words

Recount: Talk about your experience
Pick one country

2 things you learned

examples

Length

- Describe a picture writing *(1 min.)*

Length

- Describe a picture writing *(1 min.)*
- Write about a topic *(5 min & 50 words)*

Length

- Describe a picture writing *(1 min.)*
- Write about a topic *(5 min & 50 words)*
- Describe a picture speaking *(90 seconds)*

Length

- Describe a picture writing *(1 min.)*
- Write about a topic *(5 min & 50 words)*
- Describe a picture speaking *(90 seconds)*
- Talk about a topic *(90 seconds)*

Fluency and Pronunciation

- Fluency in writing
- Fluency in speaking
- Pronunciation
- Spelling & punctuation

Fluency and Pronunciation

- Fluency in writing *linking sentences and ideas*
- Fluency in speaking
- Pronunciation
- Spelling & punctuation

Fluency and Pronunciation

- Fluency in writing *linking sentences and ideas*
- Fluency in speaking
- Pronunciation *clear and a good speed*
- Spelling & punctuation